KUUZA AI

Rehearse the hard conversation before it costs you the deal.

KUUZA AI describes itself as “the Global AI Simulator and Coach for Sales, Service and All Human Communication”: voice, video and text roleplay with AI personas, scored instantly. The thesis: accent, culture and noisy-line realism for Africa, the Middle East and Asia is a wedge the funded Western tools do not target.

Investor deck · October 2026 · Cofounders Zino Mario and Excel Chukwu | `Owner-provided`
Operating base: Lagos, Nigeria | `Assumption · medium confidence` · Every claim carries its evidence status

“Born in Africa. Built for the World” | `Self-reported`

investor asks

What is broken today?

kuuza answers · the problem

New reps and service agents practise on real customers. Mistakes are paid for in lost deals, escalations and slow ramp-up.

Training is slow. The founders started KUUZA “after experiencing firsthand how painfully slow sales training can be” in a previous startup.

Self-reported · /about

Roleplay does not scale. Practice depends on a manager’s time. KUUZA’s page claims managers spend 70–80% of their time coaching (no source given).

Self-reported · unsourced

Practice tools assume a Western call. The company argues most AI platforms are “built predominantly just for Western markets”: clean lines, familiar accents, familiar norms.

Self-reported

The hard calls are emotional. Complaints with shouting, crying or sarcasm; objections; interviews; pitches. They are rarely rehearsed at all.

Self-reported · use cases

No independent survey of the problem is cited in the research. The size of the pain is an open diligence question.

investor asks

What does KUUZA actually do?

kuuza answers · the solution

A flight simulator for conversations: the user rehearses a real scenario with an AI persona that answers “with emotion, tone, attitude, and cultural nuance”. Self-reported

1 · choose a scenario

- Cold call, discovery, objection handling, upsell, demo
- Complaint and de-escalation
- Interview, negotiation, investor pitch, public speaking

2 · speak naturally

- Voice, video or text
- Persona moods “from polite to frustrated… hostile”
- Named demo personas, e.g. “Sarah — Sales AI”

3 · get scored at once

- Accuracy, tone, structure, speed, clarity, empathy, objection skill
- Speech pace, readiness score, script compliance

4 · managers see the team

- Dashboard, leaderboard, learning paths, benchmarking
- Upload scripts, FAQs and customer profiles

All capabilities as published on kuuza.ai (fetched 2026-10-18). Not independently tested for this deck.

investor asks

What can I use today, and what is only listed?

kuuza answers · product status

Capability	Where it appears	Status
Free Demo — no account, password or card; BDR/SDR/AE roleplay, video simulations, real-time feedback, transcription, objection detection; "Up to 1,000 AI calls"	Public pricing page; self-serve	Self-reported · offered publicly
Realistic audio — traffic noise, poor signal, interruptions, network delay	/features	Self-reported
Custom plan — unlimited custom bots, AI bot builder, hiring assessments, custom scorecards, real-call scoring, simulated auto-dialer	Pricing page, sold via "Book a Demo"	Self-reported · listed; live status unverified
Integrations — "CRM Integration (20+)", HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho, LMS/LXP, "SSO & Advanced Security", "Multilingual Support (30+ Languages)"	Pricing page and /features	Self-reported · live or roadmap unknown
Model and speech stack, latency, security certification	Not published	Unknown

Hero widgets on kuuza.ai ("+34% Close Rate", "11.7% Book Rate", "12 Days Streak") are illustrative UI mock-ups, not reported results. They are deliberately not used as traction here.

Most practice tools rehearse a quiet call in a Western office. KUUZA says it rehearses the call people actually get.

accents

The AI “understands accents, slang, tone, culture, and communication norms... especially within Africa, Asia and The Middle East”.

Self-reported · /features

bad lines

Simulated traffic noise, poor signal, interruptions and network delay. Uncommon in Western competitors’ marketing; fits emerging-market call reality.

Self-reported · /features

kuuza

Swahili for “to sell”. The brand is built around selling from an African starting point: “Born in Africa. Built for the World”.

Verified public · Wiktionary

What would make this a moat, not a slogan | Assumption — evaluation data on non-Western accents, a published model and vendor stack, and named customers outside the founders’ network. None of these is public yet; they are first-call diligence items.

Companies already spend heavily on training. Investors are already funding AI roleplay.

$394.5B

Global corporate training spend, 2025. Excludes consumer spend. 2026 estimate: $398.8B.

$208.2B

Of that, spend outside North America (North America: $186.4B). KUUZA's claimed home ground sits here.

$22M · $15M

Second Nature Series B (Oct 2025) and Hyperbound Series A (Sep 2025): the category is funded, mostly in North America.

`Verified public` Sources: Training Industry, "Size of the Training Industry" — trainingindustry.com/wiki/strategy-alignment-and-planning/size-of-training-industry/ · Built In NYC, 2025-10-20 — builtinnyc.com/articles/second-nature-raises-22m-series-b-20251020 · Entrepreneur India — india.entrepreneur.com/?p=87366 · all fetched 2026-10-18. Funding figures are third-party reports.

opportunity sizing · assumption arithmetic

TAM ≈ $3.9B · SAM ≈ $167M · SOM ≈ $1.7M ARR

Every line below is an Assumption. Only the two base spend figures are sourced.

TAM | Assumption	$394.5B corporate training × 10% sales and service communication training × 10% addressable by AI simulation software	≈ $3.9B
SAM | Assumption	$208.2B rest-of-world spend × 8% Africa, Middle East and South Asia × 10% communication share × 10% software share	≈ $167M
SOM | Assumption	1% of SAM within about five years	≈ $1.7M ARR
cross-check | Assumption	100 enterprise accounts × 50 seats × $30 per seat per month × 12 (KUUZA publishes no price)	≈ $1.8M ARR

The two base figures are sourced (Training Industry, fetched 2026-10-18). Every percentage, seat count and price above is an analyst assumption, not a sourced number. Consumer coaching is excluded because whether KUUZA monetises it is unknown.

investor asks

How does KUUZA make money?

kuuza answers · business model

Free self-serve demo at the top; custom enterprise plans sold through “Book a Demo”. No price is published.

Free Demo — “No Account, No Password, No Credit Card”. For individuals, small teams and founders; “Up to 1,000 AI calls”.

Self-reported · /pricing

Custom Plan (“Recommended”) — custom bots, scorecards, real-call scoring, integrations, a dedicated account manager.

Self-reported · price not published

Revenue model — enterprise contracts at custom prices, sales-led after the demo.

Assumption

Consumer — the Individuals page sells “Start Training Free →”. Whether B2C earns anything is not public.

Unknown

The page headline reads “Simple, Transparent” but shows no numeric price (fetched 2026-10-18). A price list is a founder deliverable.

Who buys, and how do you reach them?

kuuza answers · segments & distribution

segments | Self-reported

Sales teams — BDR, SDR, AE onboarding and objection handling

Customer service and call centres — de-escalation and empathy

Individuals — job seekers, students, founders, professionals

Industries named — aviation, banking, healthcare, tech, e-commerce, retail, logistics, government

distribution

Free self-serve demo, then “Book a Custom Demo” | Self-reported

“Partner With Us… training institutions & tech” | Self-reported

LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube (@kuuza-ai); newsletter; email, phone, WhatsApp, Zoom | Self-reported

Founder-led enterprise sales seeded through the founders’ network, then Nigerian SMEs and services firms | Assumption

The contact form defaults to Nigeria (+234). A one-off “HQ: Nairobi, Kenya” chip on a decorative image on /features is treated as placeholder copy, not an office; the founders should remove or confirm it.

competition

The category is real and funded. KUUZA must win where the leaders are not looking.

Competitor	Positioning	Public data point
Second Nature	AI roleplay for sales and service teams	$22M Series B, Oct 2025, led by Sienna VC; Zoom is investor and customer | Verified public
Hyperbound	AI sales roleplay and real-call scoring (YC)	$15M Series A, Sep 2025, led by Peak XV; $18.3M total | Verified public
Yoodli	AI communication and roleplay coach, individual and enterprise	Funding not verified | Unknown
FullyRamped	AI roleplay for sales reps	$2.3M raise (IT Brief UK) | Verified public
Awarathon (India)	AI video roleplay (“Trinity”)	Emerging-market comparator
Milameet (Togo)	African AI sales-simulation entrant	MIT Solve submission
Mindtickle, Gong, Zenarate, Retorio	Sales-readiness, revenue-intelligence and contact-centre simulation incumbents	Category incumbents; links not individually verified

investor asks

Why can’t Second Nature just add accents?

kuuza answers · defensibility

They could. The defensible version of KUUZA is one that owns the data and the distribution in markets the leaders under-serve. | Assumption

Local realism as data. Accent, slang and noisy-line scenarios built from African, Middle Eastern and South Asian calls compound with every customer. | Assumption

Price fit. Enterprises outside North America buy at different price points than US sales teams. | Assumption

Breadth of use. One engine for sales, service and individual practice widens the funnel — but risks diluting focus (see risks). | Assumption

Not yet public: accent evaluation data, the model and vendor stack, IP ownership, and independent customers. | Unknown

traction & proof points

Early proof is published testimonials. Most come from the founders' own network.

Zino Aviation — Rita Ekwonu (Exec. Asst to the CEO) and Olabisi Ajikanle (Head of Growth & Revenue) | Published testimonial

Related party: Zino Mario's own company. The job title differs between pages.

FDN Advisory — David Nwankwo, CEO | Published testimonial

Related party: David Nwankwo is Managing Partner of FDN Capital Partners, where Zino Mario is a Partner.

Setu Down (Nigeria) — Samson Popola, CEO: "We tested KUUZA AI"

Published testimonial

Relationship unknown. A test is not necessarily paid use.

"Nia Thompson, CEO OF Proxima" on /features | Published testimonial

Unidentifiable.

not published

Customer count	Unknown
Paying customers	Unknown
ARR or revenue	Unknown
Usage volumes, retention	Unknown

Unknown is not zero. These are the first numbers to request from the founders, with related parties separated from independent customers.

Planning assumptions — not actual results

KUUZA has published no revenue, price or cost data. The scenarios below only show how the research's seat-price assumption scales. They are not forecasts and not company figures.

Scenario	Assumption	Accounts	Seats each	$ / seat / month	ARR
Early		25	50	30	$0.45M
Research cross-check		100	50	30	$1.8M
Stretch		200	50	30	$3.6M

Arithmetic: accounts × seats × $30 × 12. Same inputs as the research's bottom-up check.

inputs still unknown

Real list price per seat or contract	Unknown
Cost per simulated minute (speech, LLM, voice, avatar vendors)	Unknown
Gross margin, latency	Unknown
Sales cycle, conversion from free demo	Unknown

Where does this go, and does it scale?

kuuza answers · roadmap & scalability

stated direction	Self-reported
“Building towards immersive Virtual Reality” (founder’s site; not on the product site)	
Hiring assessments, real-call scoring and a custom scorecard builder (Custom plan)	
“Multilingual Support (30+ Languages)” and “CRM Integration (20+)”	
Mission: “the global backbone of skills training”	

next steps the evidence calls for	Assumption
Publish terms and a privacy notice (both 404 today)	
Name the legal entity and registered office	
Publish the model and vendor stack and an accent evaluation	
Win and name independent paying customers	

Scalability | Assumption — software delivery scales across markets, but real-time voice and video usually rely on third-party speech and model APIs, so cost per minute and latency scale with vendor pricing. Unit cost is unknown.

team & founders

“Zino brought the vision, Excel brought the tech.”

Self-reported · /about

Zino Mario cofounder

Owner-provided · cofounder role

Capt. Zino Mario (Mario-Ghae): founder and CEO of Zino Aviation, Lagos; licensed pilot at 18, retired from flying at 26 (ThisDay; Nairametrics 2026-07-19)	Verified public
Raised in the UK; Sikorsky S-92 offshore pilot; two-time TEDx speaker; Partner at FDN Capital Partners. “Youngest commercial pilot” is unverified	Self-reported
Prior UK companies Pilot Pairing, Mariozino and Delta Dash Aviation — all dissolved	Verified public · Companies House

Excel Chukwu cofounder, technology

Owner-provided · cofounder role

Named cofounder on kuuza.ai/about (“Excel brought the tech”)	Self-reported
Professional background, prior roles and technical track record	Unknown
Equity and IP-assignment position	Unknown

Founder bandwidth is a diligence point: Zino Mario also runs Zino Aviation, SongScribe AI, an FDN partnership and the Man-Up Initiative.

key risks & mitigations

The risks are known and nameable. Most are fixable with documents.

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation ▌ Assumption
EU AI Act Art. 5(1)(f) — emotion recognition at work banned from 2 Feb 2025; hiring AI may be high-risk (Annex III)	Scoring employees' "empathy" or "confidence" from voice; the Custom plan lists hiring assessments	Scope scoring to skills, not inferred emotion, before any EU sale; legal review of hiring use
NDPA 2023 (Nigeria), UK/EU GDPR, US BIPA and NYC LL144	Voice, video and scores of employees are personal data; voice can become biometric	Publish privacy notice and DPA; data-residency and retention policy; avoid voice identification
Missing legal pages	/terms and /privacy-policy return 404	Publish before enterprise or investor diligence
Related-party traction	3 of 4 named stories are founder-affiliated	Report independent customers separately
Technical cofounder opacity; vendor dependency	No public footprint; IP, stack and unit cost unknown	CV, IP assignment, stack and cost per minute in the data room
Crowded category; scope sprawl; founder bandwidth; public inconsistencies	Funded US leaders; dating and preaching use cases; several ventures; Nairobi chip, mock metrics	Focus on enterprise sales and service; fix site copy; state time commitment

investor asks

How much are you raising, and for what?

kuuza answers · funding

Funding: to be confirmed by the founders. No raise, round size, valuation or use of funds has been published, and none is assumed here. | Unknown

what the founders need to supply

Amount sought, instrument and valuation expectations	Unknown
Funding raised to date (none found publicly — unknown, not zero)	Unknown
Use of funds by line: product, go-to-market, compliance, hiring	Unknown
Legal entity, jurisdiction, incorporation date and cap table	Unknown
Runway and monthly burn	Unknown

An early bet on conversation practice built outside the Western default — if the evidence lands.

the opportunity

A publicly usable product with a free demo and an enterprise plan
Self-reported

A large, sourced training budget and a funded category
Verified public

A differentiated wedge — accent, culture and noisy lines in under-served markets Assumption

A founder with a press-verified aviation operating history
Verified public; aviation is a named target industry Self-reported

Contact (published): support@kuuza.ai Self-reported

next steps — the data-room request

Entity, cap table, IP assignment, Excel Chukwu's CV

Paying customers and ARR, related parties separated

Custom-plan price list; whether B2C is monetised

Stack, cost per minute, latency; accent evaluation data

Proof that 30+ languages, 20+ CRMs and SSO are live

Privacy policy, terms, DPA, hosting location

Sources & evidence status

Source (all fetched 2026-10-18 UTC)	Status
kuuza.ai — /, /about, /features, /pricing, /contact, /faq, /success-stories, solutions pages	Self-reported
kuuza.ai/terms, /privacy-policy — HTTP 404	Verified public
zinomario.com	Self-reported
thisdaylive.com/2022/09/09/zino-aviation-takes-off-with-pilot-masterclass/	Verified public
nairametrics.com/2026/07/19/zino-aviation-ceo-why-many-licensed-nigerian-pilots-remain-unemployed/	Verified public
find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk — search “kuuza”; officer appointments	Verified public
trainingindustry.com/wiki/strategy-alignment-and-planning/size-of-training-industry/	Verified public
builtinnyc.com/articles/second-nature-raises-22m-series-b-20251020	Verified public
india.entrepreneur.com/?p=87366 · itbrief.co.uk (FullyRamped) · solve.mit.edu/solutions/95306	Verified public
wiktionary.com/wiki/uza	Verified public
search.cac.gov.ng — not queryable (JavaScript-only)	Unknown

Independent record or third-party press	Verified public
Company or founder’s own website	Self-reported
Testimonial published by the company	Published testimonial
Supplied by the Capital Q owner	Owner-provided
Analyst arithmetic or inference	Assumption
Not publicly findable; never read as zero	Unknown

Prepared offline from docs/flagship/kuuza/research.md and facts.json. No founder documents were used. Typographic wordmark only: brand assets carry no published licence.